

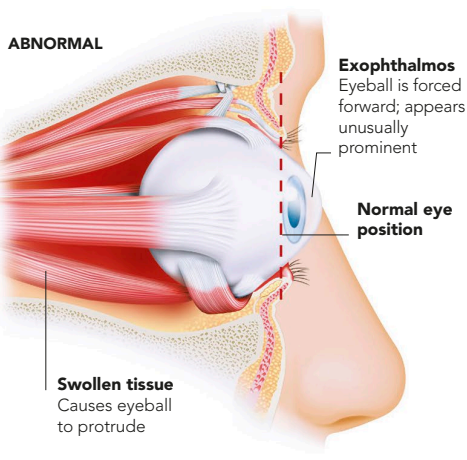
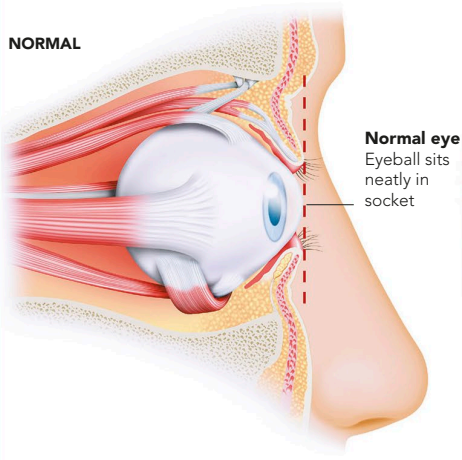
HYPERTHYROIDISM

Three-quarters of overstimulated thyroid cases are due to Graves' disease, an autoimmune disorder in which antibodies stimulate the thyroid, causing excessive hormone production. It is one of the commonest hormonal disorders, especially in women aged 20-50. A less common cause is small lumps (nodules) in the gland. Raised hormone levels push up the metabolic rate, causing weight loss due to increased energy

usage, rapid irregular heartbeat, trembling, sweating, anxiety, insomnia, weakness, and more frequent bowel movements. The enlarged thyroid may show as a swelling in the neck (goitre). Drug treatment can usually control the condition.

GRAVES' DISEASE

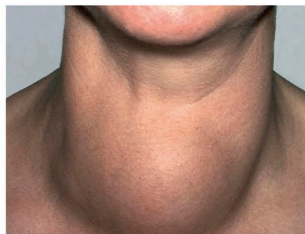
Hyperthyroidism due to Graves' disease can cause bulging eyes, giving a staring appearance and possibly blurred vision.



HYPOTHYROIDISM

In hypothyroidism, the thyroid hormones, tri-iodothyronine and thyroxine, are underproduced. As these hormones govern the speed of many metabolic processes, a lack of them leads to a slowing down of bodily functions. Symptoms of hypothyroidism include fatigue, weight gain, slow bowel activity and constipation, swollen face, puffy eyes, thickened skin, thinned hair, hoarse voice, and inability to cope with cold. The most common cause of hypothyroidism is inflammation of the thyroid gland due to an autoimmune condition called Hashimoto's thyroiditis, in which antibodies mistakenly damage the gland. The thyroid gland may swell considerably as a lump, or goitre, in the

neck. A less common cause of hypothyroidism is a lack of the mineral iodine – needed to make the thyroid hormones – in the diet. A rarer possibility is damage to the pituitary gland by a tumour.



GOITRE

A swollen thyroid (goitre) may be due to thyroiditis, hyperthyroidism, hypothyroidism, thyroid nodules, or cancer of the thyroid.